

can come in handy during meetings, gaming sessions, etc.

Microphone performance in real-world use

In testing across video calls, voice notes and multiplayer gaming sessions, the Sennheiser HD 500 BAM delivered clear, understandable audio. I don't generally like my voice out of regular microphones, but from this, the voice comes through cleanly without sounding thin. Teammates in online matches reported consistent clarity.

Compared to a built-in MacBook Air M1 microphone, the difference is immediately noticeable. The boom arm allows you to place the mic closer to your mouth, if you want. But even at a distance, the vocal presence was ample. Some background noise does seep through, but it is still way reduced. I say if you are recording a podcast professionally, you will still want a standalone mic solution.

Using it with open-back HD 560S means both me and the other person could hear loud ambient noises.

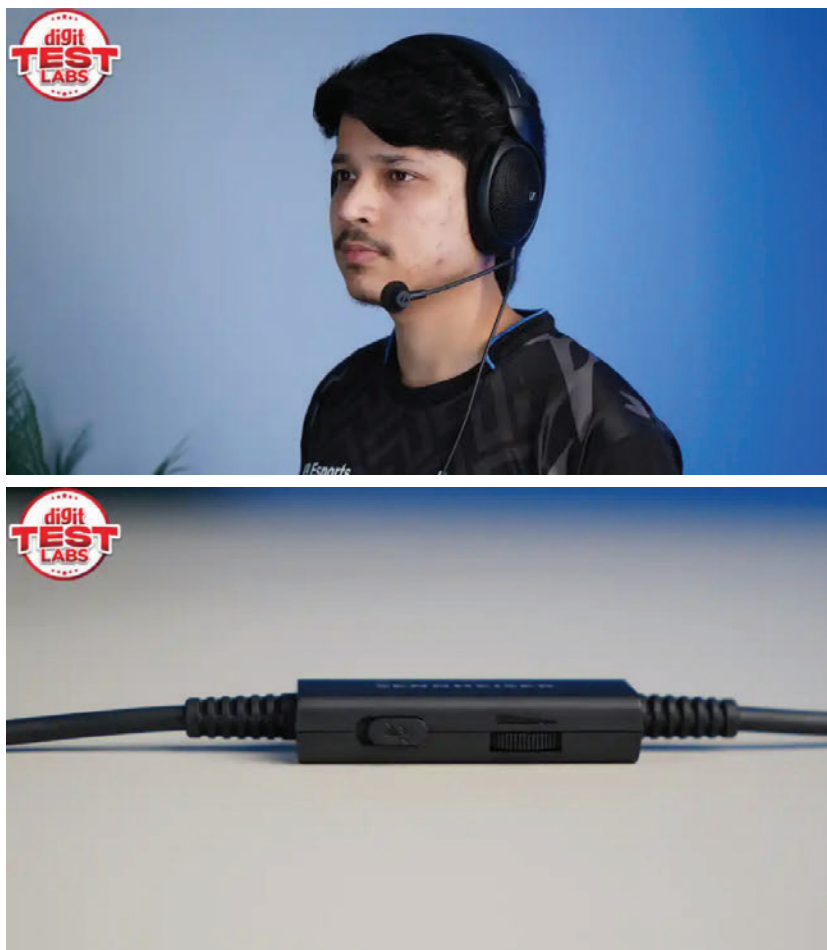
For work calls, it performed reliably on platforms such as Zoom and Google Meet. There was no distortion at normal speaking volumes. People did ask me to keep it not directly in front of the mouth. So, positioning the mic slightly to the side is advised.

Audio from HD 560S remains clear and spacious

In my testing, the Sennheiser HD 500 BAM did not noticeably alter the sound signature of the HD 560S. The headphone retained its neutral tuning, wide soundstage and tight bass response.

The low-frequency beats in Bass Dhol by Raf Sappera and Skrillex sound focused. The midrange clarity is evident in tracks like Hurt by Johnny Cash. Music also sounds spacious in all these tracks, but that and instrument separation are notable in tracks like Far From Any Road by The Handsome Family.

Over time, the HD 500 BAM shifted how I used the HD 560S.



Previously, I would switch between headphones for music and a separate headset for meetings. With the boom mic attached, the HD 560S became an all-day device. I could edit audio, take calls, join a gaming session and return to focused listening without changing headphones. I am sure this arrangement will suit a remote worker, a digital creator, and many other professionals.

But it makes sense only to those of you with a select list of Sennheiser headphones. And because of the HD 560S' open-back design, if you work in a noisy environment, both your listening and your microphone input will suffer.

Sennheiser HD 500 BAM: Should you buy it?

If you already own the Sennheiser HD 560S or a compatible 500-series model, the HD 500 BAM can turn

a pure listening headphone into a capable wired headset.

For gamers who value spacious audio and clarity over bass-heavy tuning, the HD 560S is particularly appealing and the HD 500 BAM ensures your voice is heard clearly. The combination could appeal to remote professionals, especially those in creation and editing workflows.

This is not a complete replacement for specialised gear, and the HD 500 series doesn't offer active noise cancellation headphones. It is not for everyone. But if you are someone who values neutral sound, works from a quiet room and wants a clean wired setup, the HD 500 BAM can be a clear, convenient and modular upgrade. **d**

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